Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Lakewood Village, Sunnyvale, California

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To subscribe to the Lakewood Village mailing list, send a blank email to:
lakewoodvillage-subscribe@topica.com
Visit the Lakewood Village web site at www.lvna.net

Next LVNA Meeting:

Wednesday, September 10th, 7:00 pm, Fairwood School

Magkakaroon po nang pagpupulong ang LVNA
sa 10 Setyembre, 2003, 7:00 pm sa Fairwood School

Proxima junta de LVNA sera efectuada
el 10 Septiemre, 2003 a las 7:00 pm en el Fairwood School

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News and Features

President's Column

- Phyllis Murphy

As the school year comes around again, please take a moment to make sure you talk with your children and explain to them the importance of not talking with strangers, taking the designated route home, and being aware of their surroundings. As nice as Sunnyvale and our neighborhood is in general, we should not become so comfortable that we develop a false sense of safety. All of our children should be looked out for. I say this with a heavy heart, a

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couple of weeks ago a young boy who was approximately 6 years old was molested at Fair Oaks park, right there with the park full of people and his mother only steps away. I am sure that she is feeling awful for what happened to her son. I am sure that she probably thought that he was safe after all she was in the park too, but it only takes a moment to turn around and something to happen. So please take extra care unfortunately there are some people that do not have our children's best interest in mind. ■

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Neighborhood Picnic is Saturday, September 13th

- Ursula Syrova

All Lakewood Village residents are welcome at the annual picnic on Saturday, September 13th between 11 a.m. and 4 p.m. at the Lakewood Park picnic area. This event is free and is sponsored this year by our neighbors Advanced Micro Devices (AMD) and Network Appliance, who are helping to fund supplies for the picnic. We will be grilling hamburgers and hot dogs, and this year some vegetarian alternatives will be on the menu too! Water and various kinds of soda will be provided, and we encourage everyone to bring a side dish, salad, or dessert to share. Phyllis Fowler, a Lakewood Village resident and a member of the Sunnyvale School Board will be doing face painting for the kids, and other fun activities are planned as well. Members of the

Sunnyvale City Council will be there, so here's a chance to meet some of your local government officials. Candidates for local office (City Council, Sunnyvale School Board, De Anza Board of Trustees) have also been invited, so we'll have food, fun, and the chance to influence local politics! Don't miss this opportunity to socialize with your fellow Lakewood residents. The picnic was a big success and lots of fun last year, so we hope to see you all there this year!

If you want more information about the vegetarian options, please contact Brian Smithson at editor@lvna.net or 408-738-5939.

Any monster zucchinis in your garden? We need them! If you have extra zucchini, we'd like to grill it at the picnic. Call Thom Mayer at 408-734-3935 and he will organize to get it prepared for picnic day. ■

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Dumpster Day 2003: A Successful Neighborhood Event

- Skip Gottschalk

The Lakewood Village 2003 Dumpster Day, Saturday 23 August, exceeded my expectations. There were 21 dumpsters for broken appliances, yard waste and household trash. The normal 2 day event was limited to 1 day but it certainly appeared like most people were prepared as the traffic around the dumpsters was quite busy throughout the day. Sixty dumpster loads were taken away, totaling 156.8 tons!

A SPECIAL THANKS to all the dumpster monitors who accepted the responsibility to watch over the dumpsters:

Dan Bailor
Duane Brouse
Sarah Daugherty
Judy Fernandez
Rick Flovin
Ann Gottschalk
Beverly Mansfield
Thom Mayer
Willy Rodriquez
Rick Bray
Gerlinde Daugherty
Jim Espiritu
Pat Fletcher
Fred Fowler
Jim Lane
Robert Matas
Lori Sabala
Tom Watkins

They are the main reason this event has been so successful and has continued to be supported by the City. It seems that a lot of the monitors also know how to turn the day into a nice neighborhood party (any reason is a good one!!!!!). Thanks also to the kind-hearted neighbors who brought beverages and food to some of the dumpster locations. (Here's that party thing again!!!!)

This annual event is truly a neighbor-oriented event and it was enjoyable to see the countless number of neighbors that helped each other in getting the trash to the dumpsters.

Way to go, Lakewood Village, you done good! Hope to see you all at the next LVNA meeting. ■



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October is Sunnyvale's City-Wide Fall Cleanup Month

- Skip Gottschalk

October 6th through 31st are Extra Curbside Pickup days.

Extra garbage will be picked up on your regularly schedule garbage pickup day.

Specialty Garbage will accept:

- Standard 32-gallon garbage cans weighing less than 70 pounds when filled
- Plastic trash bags up to 32 gallons in size and weighing less than 30 pounds when filled
- Furniture
- Carpets and tree trimmings, if tied in bundles shorter than 4 feet long and less than 1 foot in diameter
- Refuse in cardboard boxes smaller than 3'x2'x2' and weighing less than 25 pounds
- Cardboard boxes that have been broken down and tied in bundles no larger than 30"x30"x6"
- Metal appliances such as refrigerators, water heaters, and washers. Remove doors or securely tape doors on refrigerators and freezers. **Please call Specialty at (408) 565-9900 x800 if you have metal appliances for pick-up so they can alert their drivers.**

Specialty <u>WILL NOT</u> accept:

- Hazardous materials such as old paints, thinners, and pesticides. You can take these to the Household Hazardous Waste Drop-off Event on October 18th
- Rocks, concrete, dirt, sod, or tree stumps
- Automobile parts such as old tires, rims, wheels, engines, camper shells, car seats, or auto body parts
- Construction materials and debris, such as windows and doors, sinks and toilets, fencing, sheds, and lumber
- Loose debris such as sawdust or ashes. Box, bag, or bundle these materials for curbside pick-up or take advantage of the Extra Dump Weekends
- Television and computer monitors. These items contain cathode ray tubes (CRTs) that contain a hazardous waste. There is a $15 charge per television and/or computer monitor dropped off at the SMaRT Station.

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The weekends of October 4th/5th and 11th/12th are Extra Dump Weekends.

Sunnyvale residents can dump non-commercial refuse at the SMaRT Station at no charge. A few guidelines:

- No hazardous waste! Bring your household hazardous waste to the drop-off event on October 18th, instead.
- Asphalt, concrete, dirt, and sod require special handling by the facility. You may be diverted to a special line to unload these materials.
- No more than four (4) tires per load.
- Vehicles up to and including one-ton load ratings will be admitted. Vehicles with larger carrying capacities will not be admitted.
- A Sunnyvale resident must be inside each vehicle with each load.

For more information about Extra Curbside Pickup or Extra Dump Weekends, call (408) 730-7262. ■



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Traffic Woes from the Mercado Center: You Can Help!

- Ursula Syrova

Traffic from the Mercado Center is a big problem for certain areas of Lakewood Village, especially on Friday and Saturday nights. If you live on Blazingwood south of Sandia, you surely know what we're talking about! It can also be very difficult to turn left onto Wildwood from Sandia at those times. This extra traffic also congests the intersection of Lawrence and Sandia, as well as clogging the left-turn lane at Lawrence onto Lakehaven as people want to do U-turns to get back to 101. The City of Sunnyvale knows this is a problem and has done traffic studies to prove it, but they currently have no money budgeted to address it. New stores are still opening at the Mercado Center, so the traffic situation can only get worse. We need to get the City of Sunnyvale to acknowledge this problem again and allocate funding to do something about it.

How can you help?
Go to the next City Council meeting!

The Sunnyvale City Council has agreed to hear our concerns on this issue at their next meeting on Tuesday, September 16th. Thom Mayer, your 2nd Vice President of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association, attends council meetings and has arranged this great opportunity for us. It will make a big statement if a large group of us shows up.

The Council meeting starts at 7:30 in Council Chambers, 456 West Olive Avenue (across Olive Street from the Sunnyvale Public Library). If you would like to attend and you want more information, call or email one of the board members (see LVNA Officials on the back page).

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Background

Concern over this issue goes back to 1983 when development of the Mission College area was still just a proposal. A traffic signal at Wildwood and Lawrence has long been suggested as a solution, and the developers of the Mercado Center had even agreed to contribute money toward that traffic light project. However, solid plans for the traffic light (which would involve re-routing Wildwood to connect directly with Lawrence) have met with many problems over the years. Currently, there is no money budgeted by the City of Sunnyvale for the light (which would cost more than $3 million to construct), and the time to take advantage of the developer contribution has run out. Another option that has been considered over the years is to close Wildwood Avenue at the city limits with Santa Clara during the problem times of the day or week. This would keep Mercado traffic from heading our way, but would also keep us from getting in or out of the neighborhood that way during those times. There are pros and cons to consider for any proposal to address this problem, but the important thing right now is to get the city to agree to do something and allocate some funding.

The city did get a traffic study in the neighborhood completed in March 2002; it included a couple of neighborhood meetings for feedback. Cars were counted and the problem areas identified, but we need to keep reminding them that this problem is still here—and will probably get worse. Hearing from the people who are directly affected is the best way to do this! Show up on September 16th and help us work toward a solution. ■

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Neighborhood Enhancement Program Results

- Richard Gutierrez
Neighborhood Preservation Specialist

Some of you may remember that the City's Community Development Department met with the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association Board in May of 2002. The meeting was held to discuss a program designed to improve the overall maintenance, appearance and safety of the properties in Lakewood Village. At meeting conclusion, the City and the LVNA Board developed the "Pilot Program." 95 property owners and residents of **Lakehaven Dr., between Lawrence and Meadowlake Dr. and all of Lakenoll Dr.** worked with City staff to enhance their neighborhood.

The Pilot Program has produced great results; Highlights include the following:

- 53 properties were improved by code violation corrections including, but not limited to:
  Garage conversions
  Roof and patio extensions
  Animal control violations
  Weeds
  Inoperable vehicles
  Overgrown vegetation
- Approximately 220 gallons of paint was distributed to the Pilot Program households for free.
  9 out of 95 houses were painted.
- 5 property owners installed new driveways or expanded their old driveways to prevent vehicles from parking unpaved surfaces.
- 2 property owners removed their chain link fences.
- 12 dumpsters were filled during a City sponsored "Dumpster Day."
  This "Dumpster Day" brought the Community together in helping to revitalize a property where the property owner was disabled.
- Rebuilding Together, a non-profit, volunteer program designed to provide free repair and renovation services to elderly, disabled and low-income homeowners selected a house in the Pilot Program for rehabilitation.
  Some of the work performed included painting the inside and outside of the house, installation of a new fence, the

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  replacement of a broken window and minor repairs inside and out.
- SSA Landscape, a contracted landscape company, developed 6 front yard landscape designs and 3 park strip landscape designs.
  Landscape grants will be made available to landscape approximately 10 front yards and 14 park strips.
- The City of Sunnyvale's Department of Public Works repaired all public sidewalks and pruned all City trees.

Due to the success of the Pilot Program, revitalization of Lakewood Village shall continue under the Neighborhood Enhancement Program. Staff recently met with the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association Board and selected the new enhancement area. The new area is located between the borders of Lawrence Expressway, Fairwood Ave and the Hetch Hetchy Greenbelt, and includes approximately 185 houses.

For more details on the Neighborhood Enhancement Program please attend the next Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association meeting on September 10, 2003 at 7:00 p.m. or contact Neighborhood Preservation Specialist Richard Gutierrez at (408) 730-7447 or via e-mail at rgutierrez@ci.sunnyvale.ca.us. ■



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This is part 2 of the winning entries from the recent Lakewood Village Youth Writing Contest.

If I Was In Charge of Lakewood Village (2nd place, 3rd – 5th)

- Max J.

If I were running Lakewood Village I would put in more flowers so the fragrance would stand out. I would not allow racism so that we could all be friends. I would add more buildings to the schools so that our teachers had room for extra programs. Then we would get more education. Even though we need to add stuff, Lakewood Village it is still a great place to live because it is near everything. ☐

If I Was In Charge of Lakewood Village (2nd place, 6th – 8th)

- Bryant D.

Changing Lakewood Village

Oh, how I adore Lakewood Village! This place has nurtured me from childhood to now. Since I have the opportunity to say what I want if I was in charge, I'd finally feel power!

Anyway, I'd change the recreational activities of our neighborhood to something more exhilarating! Sure, basketball and soccer is fun, but we need to know and play sports like rugby and badminton! It'll make us more unique! We may be the city that knows more sports in our time!

Litter is gross! Our place would be brilliant if we freshen up, but there is one setback. There are people that just throw their trash on the ground! Why can't they just find a trashcan and put it in there? This will be my top priority if I was in charge!

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With these thoughts in mind, I will make Lakewood Village into a utopia! ☐

If I Was In Charge of Lakewood Village (2nd place, 9th – 12th)

- Aneta P.

If I were in charge of Lakewood Village, I would address the lack of parking and safety around Lakewood Park because it is the hub, not the downfall, of the Village.

Too many times I have passed Lakewood Park, found myself stuck in the traffic of party-goers in their cars and had no space to park my own car near my home. We cannot prevent all events from being held in the park, so the solution is to create more parking. A 20 space lot between the fence and picnic tables where the dumpster currently is, and expanding the lot next to the pool would alleviate the problem. People attending parties, baseball games and the pool would all be grateful.

Crucial items that are missing in the community are two stop signs on the intersection of Silverlake and Lakedale next to Lakewood Park. Children are constantly crossing Silverlake from the park, but often large, parked cars block drivers from seeing them. Some drivers also enjoy speeding on such a long, uninterrupted street. We cannot wait until a tragic accident finally awakens us. Stop signs would allow pedestrians to cross safely into the park and discourage speeding. A bonus would be the much-wanted increased police patrols because they would need to enforce the new signs.

If the Village does increase parking and adds a stop sign, the costs may prompt some people to want to cancel the annual Holiday Parade. I think the parade would actually be beneficial to us because revenue could be raised at the picnic after the parade. By charging $5 per adult and $3 per child (ages 4-12) and having the City chip in, we would eventually raise enough money to pay off these new and much needed additions. ☐

More contest winners will be published next month! ■

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Walkers Desperately Needed on Lakewood Side

- Wendy Stanley

I need at least two newsletter walkers, and it would be great to have relief walkers for when someone goes on vacation. The two routes I have open are:

- Twinlake Dr between Silverlake and Lakehaven (29 houses)
- Lakewood/Bridgewood between Meadowlake and the end of Bridgewood (80 houses)

If you are interested in walking please call Wendy at 745-1331. ■

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Opinions and Editorials

Letters to the LVNA

August 12th, 2003

I just got the newsletter. Thanks for running the story about my walk for breast cancer. Unfortunately we forgot to add a way for people to donate to my personal commitment amount of $2000. Can you please pass the information on to anyone who asks? They can view my personal donation page at:

https://www.kintera.org/faf/donorReg/donorPledge.asp?ievent=25308&lis=0

or,

They can write a check and add to following to the memo line:

Participant: Vicky Burns
Participant #6480776

Checks should be mailed to:

Breast Cancer 3-Day
135 LaSalle Dept. 7415
Chicago, IL 60674-7415

Best Regards,
Vicky Burns ☐

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August 17th, 2003

Dear Neighbors,

We are new to Lakewood village. Renting on Velvetlake Dr. We moved from Santa Clara where we owned our home for 20 yrs. It was much larger than the house we are renting so it is very difficult getting things in order. We recently had a complaint from the police dept. that we are parking our cars in the front yard. Regretfully this is true. Due to the fact that the first week living here my sons car was stolen. Parking space is very limited on Velvetlake Drive. Does anyone have any suggestions? I guess I just wanted to send out an apology to our neighbors and people who drive by and let them know we are working on getting things in order. We enjoy the newsletter and think that you and your staff do a wonderful job. This is a temporary residence for us but we have every intension of being good neighbors.

Sincerely,
New to the Neighborhood ■

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From the Editor's Desk

- Editor

Welcome, Ursula Syrova

Please join me in welcoming Ursula Syrova as the LVNA's new 1st Vice President! Ms. Syrova has also written two articles for this month's *LVNA Villager*.

To contact the Editor of The Villager…

Send your letters to the editor, articles, comments, and corrections by email to editor@lvna.net, by FAX to (408) 738-2821, or by postal mail to LVNA Villager, c/o Brian Smithson, 1104 Burntwood Court, Sunnyvale CA 94089. ■



This Month in Lakewood History…

- Brian Smithson

34 years ago: In 1969, Lakewood Village homes were selling for approximately $23,500.

10 years ago: In 1993, the Filipino-American Association of Lakewood Village donated a bus shelter on Lakehaven near Velvetlake. The shelter is still in use by appreciative bus riders today.

Share your history!

Are you a long-time resident of Lakewood Village? Do you have old photographs, real state brochures, newspaper clippings, or old LVRA/LVNA newsletters sitting in your garage? I'll copy items and return the originals. Call 738-5939 or email editor@lvna.net. ■

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Announcements!

LVNA General Meeting

All residents of Lakewood Village are encouraged to attend this monthly meeting. You will meet some of your neighbors, learn about upcoming events of special interest to our community, have a chance to voice your concerns and opinions, and help work towards a better neighborhood. Children are welcome.

The next meeting is:

Date: Wednesday, September 10th
Time: 7:00 p.m.
Place: **Fairwood School** ■

Lakewood School Fundraiser

- Wendy Stanley

Lakewood School will be having a fundraiser at Baskin Robbins (the Lawrence & Homestead location only) this month. The school gets half the proceeds from all they sell between 6 to 10 p.m. It is tentatively scheduled one night during the week of the 22nd. Please check the school marquee for the exact date as we get closer to the 22nd.■

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Sunnyvale Intensifies Traffic Enforcement Around Schools

SUNNYVALE, Calif. – With the start of the new school year, Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety (DPS) officers have increased enforcement of traffic safety laws around schools.

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Lt. Walt Lee of the DPS Traffic Safety Unit says Sunnyvale officers have been doing this for more than a half-dozen years. "Our goal is to educate drivers, bicyclists and pedestrians while we also enforce traffic regulations," Lee said. "All our patrol officers will be involved in this campaign and we will be working around all schools, both public and private, in Sunnyvale."

The Sunnyvale effort coincides with the countywide Operation Safe Passage. Many drop-off sites at schools cannot handle a large number of cars arriving at the same time, and this can lead to congestion and violations for double-parking and jaywalking. In order to reduce traffic congestion around schools, parents are encouraged to use carpooling or, where appropriate, have their children walk to school in groups.

As part of the public education program, traffic advisories will be distributed at all schools for students to bring home to their parents. Special advisories will be distributed at schools with unique traffic issues. ■

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LVNA Officials

President	Phyllis Murphy	president@lvna.net	617-0545
1st Vice President	Ursula Syrova	vicepresident1@lvna.net	738-3092
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Delivery (Lakewood)	Wendy Stanley	walkers@lvna.net	745-1331



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Internet Links

LVNA Web Site	http://www.lvna.net
Lakewood email list	http://www.topica.com/lists/lakewoodvillage

http://www.lvna.net/Resources/Links/links.html

Calendar of Upcoming Events

What	Where	When
Lakewood Picnic	**Lakewood Park**	**9/13, 11am**
Extra Curbside Pickup Extra Dump Weekends	In front of your house SMaRT Station	10/6 – 10/31, 6am 10/4-5, 10/11-12
Street Sweeping	Your street – move your cars!	9/9, 9/23
Bookmobile	Fairwood School	9/16?, 9/30? 3:05-3:45pm
Pediatric Mobile Health Clinic	Lakewood School	9/9, 9/23 8am – 5pm
Bookmobile	Lakewood School	9/18?, 10/2? 2:45-3:45pm
LVNA General Meeting	**Fairwood School**	**9/10 7:00pm**
Compost Workshop	Community Center	9/13 10am-noon
Household Hazardous Waste Drop-off	164 Carl Rd. Transfer Station	9/20 8am-1pm

http://www.lvna.net/Resources/Calendar/calendar.html

Important Phone Numbers

Public Safety – Emergency		**911**
Public Safety – Non-emergency		**730-7100**
Parks and Maintenance		730-7506
Animal Control		730-7178
Code Enforcement		730-7610
Crime Prevention		730-7140
Hazardous Materials		730-7212
Housing Inspection		730-7610
Lakewood Pool		734-8190
Neighborhood and Community Services	Peter Bassett	730-7739
Neighborhood Preservation	Rich Gutierrez	730-7447
Street Light Repairs		730-7510
Shopping Cart Retrieval		730-7510
NRO	Dave Falletta	730-7148
Vehicle Abatement	Michelle Raff	730-7104

http://www.lvna.net/Resources/Phones/phones.html

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